

Unwritten Fate

Introduction

The unwritten fate is an interactive fiction game that explores the tragic love story of Pedro and Inês. It utilizes the Participation-Centered Game Design Model to create an emotional and meaningful player experience. What the game is trying to achieve is to challenge and allow the player to make their own decisions based on their perception of fate and free will. All of these decisions will influence differently the story's outcome.

Dimensions of Player Involvement

1. Sensemaking (Narrative and meaning-making)

The game places the player in the roles of Pedro or Inês, offering choices that shape their relationship and destiny. The main theme revolves around love, tragedy and the illusion of control over one's fate. If the player succeeds in crafting a happy ending, they are forced to face the historical fact that such a result never occurred. The experience's emotional impact is strengthened by this metaphorical turn.

2. Playfulness (Exploration and Expression)

Through the use of a visual novel, the player engages with dialogue and branching storylines. The game features inspired illustrations and a soundtrack influenced by traditional Portuguese fado music, deepening immersion. The participation of the player in the game encourages them to explore different choices and outcomes, developing a personal connection with the characters.

3. Challenge (Emotional and Narrative challenge)

Rather than traditional gameplay difficulty, the unwritten fate presents an emotional challenge. Players must navigate moral dilemmas and face the consequences of their decisions. Although they give players a sense of control, the branching paths force them to face the weight of history and force them to consider how much influence they actually have over the plot.

Justification of Design Choices

MDA Framework: To produce an engaging experience, the three components of mechanics (branching choices), dynamics (player agency in changing events) and aesthetics (emotional resonance and historical reflection) combine.

Platform Suitability: It can be designed for PC and mobile platforms using Ren'Py or Unity, allowing for smooth interactive storytelling.

Player Engagement: The combination of meaningful choices, historical context, and emotional depth ensures a rich player experience that aligns with the goals of the Participation-Centered Game Design Model.

Conclusion

Players are invited to investigate the relationship between fate, history, and individual choice in the emotionally charged interactive fiction game The Unwritten Fate. Through the use of the Participation-Centered Game Design Canvas, the game encourages intense player participation and allows them to actively influence the story's impact.